

Chapter 131-3

Liang Shi stared at the screen for a few seconds, conveying her gratitude to the world in this way.

Then she called Wang Zhaozhao.

The one who answered was Xiao Bai, who asked nervously: "Sister Liang, what are you doing? Posting something like that on Moments is really scary. Some friends have been asking me if you're trying to end your life. I'm about to cry from fear."

"No, how could that be?" Liang Shi smiled. "By the way, why are you holding Sister Wang's phone instead of Sister Wang?"

"She's taking a shower." After saying this, Xiao Bai realized something was off and immediately explained: "She left her phone in the living room and forgot to take it. I was just about to call you when I saw you calling her, so I answered."

Liang Shi acknowledged with a soft "okay." She maintained a faint smile throughout, and called out gently: "Xiao Bai."

Xiao Bai responded: "Hmm?"

"Listen well to Sister Wang. Even though she always says she doesn't like you and looks down on you, she actually really likes you. You need to work and live steadily. I still have some money in my account—I'll transfer it all to you later. Life is so short; you need to become a better version of yourself." Liang Shi said: "I hope every day of yours will be as happy as it is now."

Xiao Bai became even more panicked. "Sis, you... why does it sound like you're giving final instructions? This isn't okay, making people feel so upset. You just woke up! Didn't you say you'd be the major investor for my bakery? You haven't even eaten the cake I baked yet..."

As Xiao Bai spoke, she started crying.

"Sis, are you at home? I'm coming to find you right now... You're not allowed to do anything stupid. Since I came here, you and Sister Wang have been the best to me. You don't know how I got through those days when you were in a coma... I, I, I..."

Xiao Bai was sobbing so hard she couldn't speak. Liang Shi's eyes also welled up with tears, but she said gently: "What are you crying for? I really won't do anything stupid. Listen to Sister Wang from now on. Tomorrow—come to my place tomorrow to bake me a cake. What ingredients do you need? I'll go to the morning market to buy them."

Xiao Bai stammered out a few items, and Liang Shi agreed to all of them.

Then Wang Zhaozhao took the phone. Her voice was flat, but even through the receiver, Liang Shi could hear her helplessness.

After a few seconds of silence, Liang Shi said gently: "Sister Wang, take good care of yourself. Find someone who treats you well and have a wonderful romance. Also, look after the little sister. Thank you for these years."

Wang Zhaozhao said coldly: "So you've finally decided?"

Liang Shi nodded: "Yes."

She said: "Perhaps I was always meant to belong there, to belong to—"

Amidst Wang Zhaozhao's sigh, Liang Shi chuckled softly, her voice becoming even gentler as she said the last two words very quietly: "—her."

Wang Zhaozhao knew she couldn't persuade her otherwise. That serious, cold voice carried a hint of choking up.

One would have thought she'd say something warm, but instead she scoffed lightly: "You really are a love-brained fool."¹

Liang Shi was immediately amused.

Xiao Bai chimed in from the side: "Exactly! Love-brained! Sister Liang, can't you pull yourself together?"

Liang Shi laughed: "Maybe... later?"

Wang Zhaozhao asked: "And what about her? Does she treat you well?"

At the mention of her, those memories in Liang Shi's mind instantly became vivid.

Xu Qingzhu always smelled so nice.

She would tell Liang Shi, "You can kiss me. No need to take responsibility."

She would come to pick her up on rainy days when Liang Shi had drunk too much.

She would accompany her to go crazy and see the ocean in the middle of the night.

She would lean into the car to kiss her when they parted, telling her: "Remember to miss me."

They kissed by the seaside, embraced in their room.

Cuddled together on the sofa watching movies.

Everything she experienced with her was something she had never experienced before.

Liang Shi paused for a moment, her voice filled with sweet laughter: "Very well."

Liang Shi said: "She's also a love-brained fool."

Otherwise, why would she abandon such a promising career and choose to marry her "sister" right after graduation?

Hearing this, Wang Zhaozhao suddenly laughed: "That's good then. Wishing you two love-brained fools a happy marriage. You..."

She paused: "Have a safe journey."

Liang Shi said: "Sister Wang, I'll remember all of you."

—Everything experienced here, and those warm, glittering days of huddling together for warmth.

Wang Zhaozhao laughed: "Mm, I know."

Liang Shi hung up the phone. With three minutes left, she chose to call Qi Jiao.

"What are you doing?" Liang Shi asked.

From Qi Jiao's end came the sound of a pen scratching on paper. She lowered her voice and said: "Writing in my diary. What's up?"

Liang Shi suddenly called out: "Jiejie."²

Qi Jiao: "Hmm?"

"Qi Jiao-jiejie, thank you." Liang Shi said sincerely: "You're not some goldfish brain. You used to be a very, very smart person. Live well, and spend every day as carefree as you are now."

Qi Jiao looked confused: "What are you talking about? Did you drink too much?"

Liang Shi smiled gently: "Then just consider me drunk. But... I want to ask you a question, and you must answer me very seriously."

Qi Jiao was bewildered, but although she didn't understand, she played along: "What is it?"

"If one day you meet Chen Mian, what would you say to her?" Liang Shi asked.

After asking, she added: "Chen Mian is a lonely and melancholic painter who has been unhappy ever since losing her lover. If... if you were her lover, what would you say to her?"

Qi Jiao hesitated and fell silent.

The countdown on the blue transparent screen in front of Liang Shi showed: 00:01:20.

Time was running out.

After hesitating, Qi Jiao answered her question very seriously: "Then tell Chen Mian to remember to listen to 'Flock of Lonely Birds'³ before going to sleep at night. Someone will love her."

Countdown: 00:00:43.

Liang Shi hung up the phone, placed it aside, and clicked on the option at the bottom.

In an instant, scattered fog obscured her eyes, and the entire world fell into a hazy state.

The night of neon lights and fine wine, the steel buildings towering into the clouds—all were tinged with a layer of mist.

Liang Shi felt as if she were floating in the air.

At that moment, the universe and galaxy spread out before her eyes, and everything she had experienced flashed through her mind frame by frame.

Memories were being stripped away from her mind.

Countless blue fragments filled the black background, streaking across like meteors.

She heard that deep voice sound by her ear:

【The World Gate is closing. Wishing everyone a pleasant life.】

Footnotes:

¹ **Love-brained fool (戀愛腦)**: A popular Chinese internet slang term referring to someone who becomes completely consumed by romantic love, often making irrational decisions or prioritizing romance above all else—essentially someone who "thinks with their heart instead of their head" when it comes to love.

² **Jiejie (姐姐)**: Chinese term for "older sister," used both for biological sisters and as a respectful/affectionate term for older women.

³ **'Flock of Lonely Birds' (孤鳥症群)**: Literally translates to "Lonely Bird Syndrome Group/Flock." This appears to be a song title mentioned in the story.